

KENINGFORD PARTNERS

C A P I T A L A D V I S O R Y

FOUNDER RESOURCE

Board Deck Checklist

What boards and management teams should include when presenting capital strategy, financing options, or transaction alternatives.

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Capital decisions are the board decisions with the longest consequences, and the quality of the decision is bounded by the quality of the materials. This checklist covers what a board deck should contain when management is presenting a financing, a transaction alternative, or a capital strategy shift, so that directors can discharge their duties on a complete record.

SECTION 01 OF 05

Executive Summary

The first page should let a director who reads nothing else still understand the decision.

- The specific decision required from the board, stated as a resolution, not a theme.
- The recommended path with a two-sentence rationale.
- The alternatives considered and the reason each was set aside.
- What changes if the board waits a quarter: the honest cost of optionality.

SECTION 02 OF 05

Business Update

Capital decisions made against a stale operating picture get relitigated. Anchor the deck in current performance first.

- Performance versus plan for revenue, gross margin, EBITDA, and cash, with variance explanations rather than restated targets.
- Key risks and mitigants, updated from the prior meeting rather than copied forward.
- Pipeline and retention indicators that support or challenge the forward plan the financing is built on.

SECTION 03 OF 05

Capital Context

- Current capital structure: instruments outstanding, preference stack, covenant positions, and maturity schedule.
- Runway under base and downside cases, with the assumptions that separate the two.

- Financing alternatives compared side by side on dilution, control terms, cost of capital, and execution risk, not on headline price alone.
- Market timing considerations, supported by comparable transactions rather than sentiment.

SECTION 04 OF 05

Process and Governance

- Proposed timeline with decision gates the board will own, so directors know when they will be asked to act.
- Advisors engaged or proposed, with scope and fees.
- Conflicts identified and managed: insider participation, investor-appointed directors on both sides of a decision, and any related-party dimensions.
- Fiduciary considerations counsel has flagged, documented in the record.

SECTION 05 OF 05

Appendix Standards

- Full model output for the scenarios referenced in the body, so the board sees the machinery, not just the conclusions.
- Preference waterfall under at least three exit values.
- Term sheet or indicative terms in full, not summarized, when a specific instrument is on the table.

NEXT STEP

Put this to work with our team

This resource is part of the Keningford Partners founder toolkit. If you are preparing for a capital raise, sale process, or board decision, our team will review your materials against this framework and tell you where the gaps are, at no cost.

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